Coach Orientation

Science on the Court · 2026-27

Everything a new coach needs before the first afternoon: paperwork, training, pay, the site, child-safety rules, and how a session really runs.

What we'll cover

- Documents, and the secure form they go through
- Training: the two you need now, the ones we pay for later
- Pay, invoices, reimbursement
- Your site, schedule and contacts

- Child-safety rules that are never bent
- SOTC core values
- How a grade 2–3 session actually runs
- What we learned the hard way
- Your ramp from shadow to lead

Before you're in the room: documents

Upload everything through the SOTC Instructor Clearance Upload form. Never email an ID, W-9 or test result.

Safe Passages & OUSD require

- Live Scan on the OUSD form — the **ATI number**
- TB test **result** (not the receipt), within 3 years
- Mandated Reporter certificates: **General + School Personnel**
- Diploma photo or unofficial transcript
- Government photo ID, unexpired
- Resume (we have yours from your application)

SOTC requires

- SafeSport Trained Core certificate, within 30 days of your first session
- Signed personnel packet, pages 1–3, after reading the Operations Manual
- Signed Code of Conduct, one page
- Signed Independent Contractor Agreement
- Signed IRS Form W-9
- Two professional references
- Headshot, for the school newsletter and your site badge

You are not on site until Safe Passages confirms clearance in writing. SOTC will tell you the day it lands.

Training

Mandated Reporter before you're in the room, SafeSport within your first 30 days. The rest is encouraged and reimbursed.

COURSE	WHERE	COST · TIME	STATUS
Mandated Reporter — General, then School Personnel	mandatedreporterca.com	Free · 2–4 h	**Required before contact** · renew yearly
SafeSport Trained Core	safesporttrained.org · organization ID "N/A"	$20 · 90 min	**Required within 30 days of first session** · renew yearly
Classroom Behavior Management, Parts 1 & 2 (Elementary)	IRIS Center, Vanderbilt	Free · 2 h each	Strongly encouraged for grades K–5
Stewards of Children	d2l.org	$16 · 2.5 h	Encouraged · reimbursed
CPR / First Aid (Red Cross blended)	Red Cross, Oakland	$75–110 · half day	Required only if you are the sole SOTC adult at a site

Upload each certificate to the form as you finish it. Certificates live in your personnel file and are checked every September.

Pay, invoices, reimbursement

Rate

$25 / hour

In-person instruction, per your contractor agreement. Prep time is built into the rate; tell SOTC if a session needs more than 15 minutes of setup.

Invoices

- Accepted on the **1st and 15th** of each month
- Dates and hours worked, rate, total
- Your contact info and Zelle or direct-deposit details
- Email to info@scienceonthecourt.com
- Miss the date and the payment waits for the next one

Reimbursement

- Live Scan, TB test and SafeSport fees
- Attach receipts to your **first invoice after clearance**
- Other items only if approved in advance
- Allow 7 business days

Where we work

SOTC confirms your site, days and start date once you are cleared. Each site has its own screening path (see the onboarding page).

East Oakland Pride Elementary

OUSD · Safe Passages after-school

Grades 2–3, Tue/Thu afternoons, three 6-week cohorts a year. Math and STEM through SPIKE Prime cars and the court.

Screening: OUSD Live Scan + TB + Safe Passages roster.

John Muir Middle School

SLUSD · Boys & Girls Clubs of San Leandro

Year-long after-school Python robotics with basketball. 45-minute coding sessions, tiered tables.

Screening: SLUSD Live Scan + TB + district certifications form.

Allen Temple Baptist Church

Community site, East Oakland

Evening program, basketball plus STEM labs, when in session. Restarting in 2027.

Screening: Sterling Volunteers check + church volunteer session.

Every site

Child safety: never bent

These come from the Operations Manual §4 and the Code of Conduct you sign.

Two adults, always

- Never alone with a student. Doors open, sight lines clear
- Restrooms: walk the group, stay outside the door, in view of another adult
- Never transport a student in a personal vehicle
- If you end up as the only adult, move to where host staff can see you or end early

Contact and communication

- OK: high-fives, fist bumps, handshakes, shoulder pats, spotting after you ask
- Not OK: hugs beyond a brief side hug the child starts, lap-sitting, tickling, piggybacks, any discipline by touch
- No personal phone, email or social media contact with students or families. All contact goes through SOTC channels
- No gifts, tutoring, babysitting or rides outside the program

You are a mandated reporter. Suspected abuse or neglect goes to law enforcement or CPS directly, and to SOTC's Child Safety Officer the same day. Reporting internally alone does not satisfy the law.

Core values

- **FUN** — If we're not having fun, they're not learning.
- **LEARNING** — Every session should spark curiosity and growth.
- **CHALLENGE** — Push students, and yourself, to improve every time.
- **ENGAGE EVERYONE** — Reach the kids who aren't engaged without losing the group.
- **PROFESSIONALISM** — You may be young, but you are not a peer.
- **ELIMINATE CHAOS** — Structure brings freedom. Keep the energy focused.

At East Oakland Pride these sit on top of the school's Pride values: Pride, Respect, Integrity, Determination, Empowerment. Use the school's words with the kids.

How a grade 2–3 session actually runs

Rebuilt after Day 1. The board is a scoreboard the kids feed. No slides, ever.

MOVE
A car run, a shot, a sprint. Something happens.

MEASURE
A kid holds the stopwatch or tape and reads the number aloud.

COMPUTE
The number goes on the board. The class does the math with it.

EXPLAIN
One kid says why. In their words.

EARN
SOTC dollars pay out only once the math is on the wall.

The tools

- Four SPIKE Prime cars, time trials and races. Jobs rotate. The whistle is the only rule
- SOTC money: payday at the start, fines for chaos, store at the end
- Chromebooks are a station, not the class

Your job during free play

- Three minutes one-on-one with each kid while the others play
- Change one variable per session, never the whole shape
- Attendance and SOTC-dollar ledger kept as you go

A typical hour

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT THE ADULT IS DOING
3:45	Set up	Cars charged, board drawn, store stocked, name tents out, run card in your pocket
4:00	Door quiz, 5 min	Speed Math strip at the table. Quiet start. It is the day's baseline
4:05	Payday + today's job	Everyone gets paid. Announce the one new variable
4:10	Trials and free play	Rotate timers, drivers, recorders. Pull kids 1:1 for three minutes each
4:35	Compute at the board	Kids bring the numbers up. Whole class does the math. One kid explains
4:50	Store	Spend SOTC dollars. Fines and bonuses settle here
4:57	Clean up, attendance	Cars in the bin, board photographed, attendance sent to info@ before you leave

The run card for each session is in the cohort folder. Follow it, then tell your site lead what you'd change.

Case study: Everforward Young Men's Conference

The plan

50 minutes, three stations, designed for 15 students.

1. Shooting drill → track makes and misses → calculate field-goal percentage
2. Timed drill → compute speed
3. Steal the Bacon game

What happened

Two groups of 7 and 5 arrived. Station 3 was never reached. A new coach led parts of the second group: high energy, strong connection, lost track of the made-shot count and the math language.

Key learnings

- Always plan more activities than time allows
- Expect group sizes and timing to shift
- Depth over breadth: go deeper where kids are engaged
- Simplify or remix drills on the spot
- Energy is not enough. Someone must hold the numbers

What we learned the hard way at East Oakland Pride

Day 1, Oct 27

- Slides and a talk. Several rambunctious kids. The plan collapsed in ten minutes
- The one thing that worked: kids running stopwatches and reading "1.84 seconds" out loud

Day 2, Oct 29

- Smaller room, SOTC money, four cars, races, store
- Three minutes one-on-one per kid while the others played
- Calm room. Math on the wall. Keep this shape

Rules that came out of it: no slides for grades 2–3 · nothing pays until the equation is on the wall · the whistle is the only rule · change one variable per session.

Site responsibilities

In the room

- No phone during class except as a stopwatch or camera for the board
- No eating or drinking during instruction
- Wear the SOTC shirt or hoodie we give you
- Keep the space organized; leave it the way Safe Passages needs it
- Use the school's Pride values language

Records

- **Attendance every session**, present and absent, sent to info@scienceonthecourt.com before you leave the building. The contract requires it reach Safe Passages the same day
- Photograph the board at the end of each session
- Any incident, injury or near-miss: tell your site lead the same day; written report within 24 hours
- Communicate problems early, not after they grow

Your ramp: from shadow to lead

1 · Cleared
Safe Passages confirms. Not before.

2 · Shadow
The site lead leads. You run the timers and the store, learn names.

3 · Co-lead
You take one block of the hour, then two.

4 · Lead
You run the room. The site lead stays in the room for your first two weeks.

5 · Own it
SOTC observes periodically and is at each cohort finale.

Each step is a conversation, not a date. We move when the room says we can. Your first program cycle includes check-ins with your site lead after sessions, which is how the Operations Manual says every new coach starts.

Support and next steps

Reach out any time

- Questions, or not sure how to proceed: **info@scienceonthecourt.com**
- Your site assignment email gives you a direct contact
- Onboarding page: dobohler1.github.io/sotc-curriculum/onboarding

This week

- Upload the documents on slide 3 through the clearance form
- Finish Mandated Reporter now and upload it; SafeSport within 30 days
- Read the Operations Manual; sign the packet and Code of Conduct
- Return the contractor agreement and W-9 through the form
- Read the current run card in the cohort folder